objectives. Despite the fact that jihadis constitute an incredibly small minority among Muslims, significant variegation exists within the jihadi movement over these objectives as well as a range of other issues, including which enemy to prioritize, where to fight, whether it is ever appropriate to make war against a Muslim regime, what to do about the Shia and whether it is permissible to kill other Sunni Muslims. There are also significant disagreements about the importance of dawa, with some jihadis advocating for a greater emphasis on non-violent outreach and others promoting a violence-only approach. How a jihadi group addresses these issues generally comes from a combination of its doctrinal precepts and strategic calculation.

Jihadis can be classified in a number of ways. This book employs a typology devised by Thomas Hegghammer, which focuses on the political content and strategic calculus of an actor's ideology. He posits five main rationales for Islamist activism: state-oriented, morality-oriented, sectarian, nation-oriented and umma-oriented. In each case, violent or non-violent approaches may be employed. Hegghammer argues that multiple rationales often motivate a jihadi group, but that traditionally a group had one dominant rationale guiding its violent behavior at a given time.[1] However, he also observes that there has been a trend toward ideological hybridization since the early- to mid-part of this decade, which has made it more difficult to determine what some jihadi outfits are fighting for.[2] Thus, when classifying jihadi rationales for activism, it is important to keep in mind that these are ideal types. The following summarizes descriptions drawn from Hegghammer's typology.[3]

State-oriented activism refers to a focus on changing the social and political order of the state. Its non-violent manifestation is reformism and its violent form is socio-revolutionary jihad. Socio-revolutionary jihadis prioritize defeating impious Muslim regimes, often termed the 'near enemy' and replacing them with men who will rule by sharia. This approach declares Muslim rulers to be kuffaar, or unbelievers, which most Muslims believe is not theologically justifiable unless the leader 'willingly implements non-Islamic law, understands that it does not represent Islam, and announces that it is superior to Islam.' This traditional reading of apostasy requires absolute proof of intentions, something that is nearly